Akash Kollabathula

SDET | Playwright + TypeScript Automation Engineer | AI-Assisted Testing

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

SDET / Playwright Automation Engineer with **3 years of experience** designing and maintaining **Playwright and TypeScript** automation for web applications and **REST APIs**. Builds reliable **end-to-end UI and API test suites**, validates business workflows such as registration, booking and payments, and runs regression in **CI/CD pipelines on GitHub Actions and Jenkins**. Experienced in **test strategy, test planning, release validation and defect triage**. Applies **AI-assisted testing** with Playwright agents, the **Playwright MCP Server**, **Claude** and GitHub Copilot to speed up test design, generation and maintenance.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages: JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, Java, SQL

Automation: Playwright, Playwright Test, E2E and UI Automation, Cross-Browser Testing, Browser Contexts, Parallel Execution, Auto-Wait, Web-Assertions,Locators,XPath, CSS Selectors.

Frameworks & Design: Page Object Model, Fixtures, Hooks, Reusable Utilities, Data-Driven Testing, Trace Viewer

API Testing: API Automation Framework, REST API Testing, Playwright APIRequestContext, Postman, JSON Schema, SQL Verification

AI-Assisted Testing: Playwright Agents (Planner, Generator, Healer), Playwright MCP Server, Claude, GitHub Copilot

Testing: Functional, Regression, Smoke, Sanity, Integration,Exploratory Testing, Test Case Design, Bug Reporting

Quality & Release: Test Strategy, Test Planning, Defect Triage, Release Validation, Hotfix Verification, Sign-Off

CI/CD & Tools: GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Git, Allure, Jira

Methodology: Agile/Scrum, Agile Ceremonies, SDLC, Defect Lifecycle Management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer – QA Automation · *HCL Technologies (Full Time)* **Dec 2023 – Present**

Playwright + TypeScript · REST API · SQL · GitHub Actions · Jenkins · Jira

- Developed and maintained the team's **Playwright Test + TypeScript** automation framework using **Page Object Model**, custom fixtures, hooks and reusable utilities, achieving **60%+ automation coverage** test cases automated across critical product workflows.
- Reduced regression execution time by implementing **Playwright parallel workers** and optimizing test execution, enabling faster feedback in **Continuous Testing** cycles.
- Improved test suite stability by reducing flaky tests from **25% to below 15%** through reliable locators, auto-waiting, web-first assertions and synchronization improvements.
- Integrated automation suites with **GitHub Actions and Jenkins** for automated regression execution, Allure reporting and artifact archival; managed defects in Jira.
- Logged, tracked and managed **120+ defects in Jira**, collaborating with developers to reduce defect turnaround time.
- Automated **50+ REST API test cases** using **Playwright APIRequestContext** and Postman, validating status codes, response payloads, **JSON schema**, **API contracts** and database records.
- Performed **SQL backend validation** to cross-verify UI data against database records, uncovering data synchronisation defects invisible from the front end.
- Provided **production release support**, including pre-go-live sanity testing, hotfix verification and formal sign-off across multiple sprint releases.
- Leveraged **Playwright MCP Server and Planner, Generator and Healer agents** for browser exploration, scenario identification, locator discovery and test generation. Used **Claude and GitHub Copilot** for code suggestions, refactoring and debugging, reducing test authoring time by approximately **40%**.
- Improved defect investigation by attaching Playwright traces, screenshots, videos and execution artifacts to Jira defects,
- Participated in sprint planning, stand-ups and retrospectives with developers and product teams to clarify requirements and support **Test Planning** and **Defect Triage**.

PROJECTS

Builder Management Tool · *Real-time Plot Management and Booking Web Platform* **Jan 2024 – Present**

Playwright · TypeScript · POM · REST API · SQL · Jira

- Worked on a web-based property management platform supporting **customer registration**, **sign-in** and **property discovery** through plot availability searches across towers, buildings and floors.
- Covered end-to-end **property booking workflows**, including booking confirmation, customer and booking ID validation, and **advance payments** followed by scheduled installments.
- Tested the platform's REST APIs with Playwright **APIRequestContext** and Postman, validating status codes, response payloads and negative scenarios alongside UI flows.
- Used **GitHub Copilot and Playwright Agents** to draft tests for new features and update locators after UI changes; ran **regression and smoke suites** in CI and reported failures with traces.
- Validated **plot availability search results** across towers, buildings and floors, including unavailable and booked plots.

Google Drive Web · *Google Client Project* **Dec 2023 – Dec 2024**

Manual-Testing · Sanity · Google Drive · Google Docs · Sheets · Slides · Shared Drives

- Built **file upload and download workflows** for Google Drive, handling documents, spreadsheets and media.
- Enabled **file preview and sharing** so team members could view and share files quickly without extra steps.
- Managed **Shared Drives** and organized folders to keep project files structured and easy to find.
- Assigned **access levels** (Viewer, Commenter, Editor) to control who could view, comment on or change each file.
- Created **Google Docs, Sheets and Slides** automatically, saving teams time on repetitive document setup.
- Applied **labels** to files and folders to make them easier to search, filter and track.
- Validated **file preview, sharing and access-level permissions** across Shared Drives to confirm Viewer, Commenter and Editor restrictions worked as specified.
- Tested **folder organization and file labelling** to confirm uploaded files were categorized correctly and easy to search and filter.

OWNERSHIP & KEY CONTRIBUTIONS

- Owned regression runs for **release cycles** and flagged blockers to the team before sign-off.
- Independently analyzed requirement gaps and raised early risks, reducing rework and defect leakage.
- Mentored junior QA members on **test case design** and **defect reporting** best practices.

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

- **Spot Award** – Recognized for ownership, proactiveness and exceptional support in testing critical issues.
- **Execution Excellence Award (FY24–25 Q2)** – Honored for outstanding project contributions and high-quality deliverables.
- **Execution Excellence Award (FY25–26 Q3)** – Acknowledged for a key role in supporting multiple teams and delivering excellence.

EDUCATION

B.Tech – Computer Science and Engineering **2019 – 2023**

Vignan Institute of Information Technology, Visakhapatnam CGPA: 8.2 / 10